

FINDSTER

Your Campus Sidekick for Lost & Found
Product Portfolio Document

1. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Students and staff on college campuses frequently misplace personal belongings — from everyday items like water bottles, ID cards, and headphones to high-value possessions such as debit/credit cards and jewellery. Without a centralized, accessible way to report or recover these items, many are never returned to their rightful owners.

🔑 Key Insight: Most campuses rely on a physical lost-and-found box that is poorly publicized, rarely checked, and entirely offline — making recovery a matter of luck rather than process.

2. BUSINESS REQUIREMENT DOCUMENT

2.1 Why This Product?

"Ever lost your ID or earbuds on campus? Yeah, us too. Those lost & found boxes? Half the time, no one knows where they are. That's why we built Findster — a simple, student-friendly app that lets you report or browse lost items in seconds. No awkward emails, no dead ends — just a fast way to get your stuff back."

2.2 Product Goals

Feature	Description
Easy Platform	Provide a frictionless digital space for students and faculty to report and discover lost or found items.
Speedy Recovery	Accelerate item returns by making it simple to search, filter, and post listings — reducing time-to-recover.
Safe & Private	Enable secure, anonymous communication between users, eliminating the need to share personal contact details.
Continuous Growth	Collect structured feedback and analyze usage data to iteratively improve the platform post-launch.

2.3 Scope — Minimum Viable Product (MVP)

The MVP focuses on a streamlined, functional platform that enables students and faculty to report, browse, and recover lost or found items with minimal friction. It solves the core problem efficiently while establishing a scalable foundation for future enhancements.

Core MVP Features

Feature	Description
Item Posting	Users create posts for lost/found items including a photo, description, date, location, and category (e.g., electronics, books). Consistent format enables quick scanning.
Search & Filtering	Browse all listings or narrow by category, location, or date. Designed to accelerate matching on a busy, multi-building campus.
Secure Communication	In-app messaging or masked email keeps personal information private during the coordination process.
Post Management	Users edit, mark as Claimed, or delete posts from a personal 'My Posts' dashboard — maintaining platform accuracy over time.

Future Scope

- Admin Moderation Panel — Dedicated dashboard for campus admins to review posts, verify claims, and flag inappropriate content.
- Push Notifications & Auto-Matching — Real-time alerts when similar items are posted; smart matching by type, location, and time.
- Campus-Wide Broadcast Alerts — Admins push urgent notifications for high-priority items (e.g., ID cards, electronics).
- Map-Based Item Location — Interactive map pins showing exactly where items were lost or found.
- Unclaimed Items Resale / Donation — Items held 120 days with no owner claim enter a transparent resale/donation cycle; revenue supports app maintenance and charity.

Scaling Strategy

🔗 Dual Revenue Model: (1) Non-intrusive in-app ads on item pages and search results, and (2) Subscription-based institutional access for colleges, unlocking admin features, usage insights, and dedicated support. This model keeps Findster free for students while generating sustainable revenue.

2.4 Target Audience

Segment	Role	Needs & Context
🔗 Students	Primary Users	Main users who frequently misplace everyday items. Value quick, mobile-first recovery. Drive the network effect at launch.

🔗 Faculty & Staff	Secondary Users	Discover lost items in offices and classrooms, or occasionally lose belongings. Appreciate a simple, no-learning-curve tool.
🔗 Campus Admins	Platform Operators	Oversee the platform, moderate posts, verify sensitive claims, and send campus-wide alerts. Ensure Findster stays trustworthy and secure.

3. PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

3.1 User Stories

As a Student

- I want to post a lost or found item with a photo and details so that others can see and help recover it.
- I want to search and filter listings by category, location, and date so I can quickly locate my missing item.
- I want to chat securely with someone who found my item so I can coordinate the return without sharing personal contact info.
- I want to mark my item as 'Claimed' once it's returned so the platform stays accurate and up to date.

As a Faculty Member

- I want to report items I find around campus so that other users can recover them easily.
- I want a simple, intuitive interface that requires no technical training or onboarding.

As a Campus Admin

- I want to moderate posts and verify sensitive item claims to prevent platform misuse.
- I want to send urgent broadcast alerts for high-value items to all registered users.

3.2 Acceptance Criteria

Feature	Description
Posting Flow	Users upload an image and complete item details (description, category, date, location) in under 60 seconds.
Search & Filters	App allows browsing all items with filtering by category, location, or date to improve findability.
Secure Chat	Messaging occurs entirely within the app, with no personal contact details exposed to either party.
Post Management	Each user has a 'My Posts' section to edit, delete, or mark items as Claimed.
Admin Dashboard	Admins can view all posts, flag inappropriate content, verify sensitive claims, and send broadcast alerts.

Notifications	Users receive real-time push notifications for potential matches and urgent admin alerts.
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3.3 Success Metrics

Metric	Target	Description
Adoption	70% in 3 months	Active students and staff onboarded within the first three months of launch.
Item Recovery	≥ 60% claimed	Percentage of posted items marked as Claimed within 7 days of posting.
Posting Time	< 60 seconds avg	Average time for a user to create a new listing from start to submission.
Safety	0 incidents	Reports of misuse, contact detail leaks, or privacy violations in Phase 1.
Engagement	50+ posts/month	Minimum number of new item listings per month at the time of launch.
Alert Open Rate	≥ 80% within 1 hr	Percentage of users who open urgent broadcast alerts within one hour of delivery.

Findster | Built for campuses. Designed for students.

Let's make campus life a little less chaotic — one item at a time.